

Woodward Academy Model UN Conference Handbook

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WAMUN Policies

The WAMUN conference is an opportunity for students to learn and familiarize themselves with international relations by embracing communication, collaboration, critical thinking, and problem solving skills to develop solutions to issues threatening the world.

The health and safety of all WAMUN delegates are our highest priority. To ensure a secure environment for all participants at this conference, we ask all delegates to follow these guidelines. The WAMUN Secretariat and sponsors will handle violations of guidelines on a case-by-case basis.

1. Delegates should be dressed in Western Business Attire while committees are in session.
2. Delegates are expected to be timely to all committee sessions.
3. Delegates are expected to be respectful to all participants of the conference.
4. Delegates are not permitted to leave campus unless with an adult and the Secretariat are noted of the leave.
5. Use and possession of weapons, illegal substances, and alcohol are not permitted.
6. Delegates are permitted to use technology such as laptops for this conference. However, the use of technology is only permitted for the purpose of committee sessions. Delegates should not use their cell phones, social media, or other distracting platforms during committee sessions. Chairs of individual committees may take away the privilege of using technology in the event of disrespectful use of technology during committee sessions.
7. Delegates are encouraged to pass notes during committee sessions. These notes will be read and distributed by the Page. If there are any notes deemed disrespectful or harmful, the note will be given to the Chair, who may determine any potential consequences.

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Parliamentary Procedure

Roll Call

The Chair calls the country, and the delegate responds with “present” or “present and voting.”

“Present” - the delegate may abstain from voting on substantive matters
“Present and voting” - the delegate may not abstain from voting and must vote either yes or no

Remember: *all* delegates must vote for procedural matters such as motions for caucuses; however, those who elect to be “present” may abstain from voting for resolutions and amendments.

Speakers List

The chair will ask if there are any points or motions on the floor. After roll call, the first task of the committee is to set the agenda, which, in WAMUN, will go straight to opening the Speaker’s List because each committee only has one topic.

A delegate may motion to open the Speaker’s List which is automatic. This list is always open, so delegates may ask to be added at any time by sending a note to the Chair. The Chair may decide when the Speakers List should pause in order to move into debate.

Once the Speaker’s List has been exhausted, the committee automatically enters Voting Procedure.

Yields

Yields can only be made during the Speaker’s List. If a delegate has used part of their speaking time (for example: 30 seconds of their 1 minute time), then the delegate may yield the rest of the time to the chair, to questions, or to another delegate.

“I yield my time to the chair” - the remaining time is unused
“I yield my time to questions” - the Chair will call on a delegate wishing to ask the speaker a question and the speaker can only respond with the amount of time remaining
“I yield my time to [country]” - the country the speaker has called upon may accept or deny the yield; if the delegate accepts, then they have the rest of the yielded time to speak

Points

Points are not related to the substance of the committee. Delegates should raise their placard and wait to be called upon by the Chair.

"Point of Order" - delegates may use this to point out a discrepancy in parliamentary procedure or another delegate's actions
"Point of Personal Privilege" - delegates may use this to ensure that they have the resources necessary for committee such as room temperature
"Point of Inquiry" - delegates may use this to clarify a motion, consideration, or any steps of parliamentary procedure

Caucuses

Caucuses require a motion voted upon by a majority of the delegates.

1. Moderated Caucus - informal debate

"The delegate of [country] motions for a 12:00 moderated caucus with :45 speaker times on [topic]."
Note that the time of the caucus and speaker times may be amended by the Chair.

The delegate that posed the motion may elect to speak either first or last. During a Moderated Caucus, the Chair may call on any country that has their placard raised and that country may speak for the allotted speaking time.

2. Unmoderated Caucus - suspension of the meeting

"The delegate of [country] motions for a 10:00 unmoderated caucus"
Note that the time of the caucus may be amended by the Chair.

During an Unmoderated Caucus, delegates may suspend formal debate to leave their seats and discuss topics freely with other delegates. Delegates should use this time to develop relationships with countries, propose their stances on topics, develop blocs, and draft resolutions. Unmoderated caucuses should not exceed 20 minutes.

3. Seated Unmoderated Caucus - formal unmoderated caucus

"The delegate of [country] motions for a 10:00 *seated* unmoderated caucus"
Note that the time of the caucus may be amended by the Chair.

During a Seated Unmoderated Caucus, delegates may suspend formal debate but must remain seated. Delegates have the opportunity to ask other delegates questions about working papers and blocs without an unmoderated or moderated caucus. In this form, the Chair does not moderate the committee, so delegates are able to speak freely. Unmoderated caucuses should not exceed 20 minutes.

Resolutions and Amendments

Resolutions

Resolutions aim to develop and create innovative solutions to the topics presented in the committee. Resolutions are made up of sponsors and signatories who contribute to and support the resolution.

- Sponsors: countries who agree with and contribute to the content of the resolution. Delegates who sign a resolution as a sponsor *must* contribute by writing preambulatory or operative clauses.
- Signatories: countries who would like to see the draft resolution debated but they do not necessarily agree with all parts of the resolution, so they do not have to vote for the resolution.

Resolutions must have 2 sponsors and at least ⅛ of the members of the committee as signatories.
Resolutions cannot exceed 8 Sponsors.
Resolutions require a simple majority to pass

The number of draft resolutions accepted before voting procedure may be at the discretion of the Chair.

Amendments

There are two types of amendments that may be proposed: friendly and unfriendly amendments

Friendly Amendments

- Approved by all sponsors of the resolution
- Mainly contain non-substantive matters that do not alter the content of the resolution; however, these amendments may be substantive
- Automatically added without a vote.

Unfriendly Amendments

- not approved by the sponsors of the resolution prior submission to the Chair
- require the same number of sponsors as the draft resolution
- require two speakers for and against the amendment(s) and a majority vote to be added to the draft resolution

Submitting a Resolution

A resolution is considered a "working paper" until submitted to the Chair, a "draft resolution" until presented to the committee, and a "resolution" once voted upon.

Draft resolutions are presented to the committee in the order in which they are submitted. They are titled based on the topic(s) of the committee (example: Resolution 1.1 is the first resolution submitted for the first topic).

Presenting a Resolution

During the presentation of the resolution, one or more sponsors will read the resolution to the rest of the committee. After the reading, there will be a Question and Answer Panel.

Questions asked by delegates chosen by the Chair may be answered by the sponsors of the resolution. Questions may entail non-substantive or substantive matters. Non-substantive questions are used to question grammar or clarify parts of the draft resolution. Substantive questions are used to question the meaning and intentions of the draft resolution.

- Time allocation for questions and answers will be at the discretion of the Chairs.

Voting

There are four main methods to vote for a resolution that require a simple majority to pass:

1. Roll call vote — "motion for a roll call vote" or "motion to vote by roll call" is automatically adopted by the Chair who calls on countries in alphabetical order to state their vote similarly to roll call at the beginning of the committee session.

2. Placard vote — "motion for a placard vote" is automatically adopted by the Chair who asks delegates to raise their placards for or against the draft resolution.

3. Divide the question — "motion to divide the question" omits specific lines, sub-clauses, or other parts of the draft resolution that should be voted on separately from the entire draft resolution.

4. Unanimous consent/Vote by acclamation — "motion for a vote by acclamation" is automatically adopted by the Chair who asks if there are any objections to the resolutions; if there are no objections within three consecutive taps of the gavel, then the resolution automatically passes.

Course of Debate: General Assembly

At the beginning of each committee session, the Chair will take Roll Call, where delegates state whether they are present or present and voting. After roll call, the Chair will ask if there are any points or motions on the floor. At this point, the Chair looks favorably on a motion to open the Speaker's List. Delegates will vote on the motion, and, if it passes, the Chair will call on delegates to present a speech on the given topic. If there is more than one topic in the committee, then a delegate should motion to Set the Agenda, where delegates can vote on which topic to debate first.

After exhausting the Speaker's List (at the Chair's discretion), delegates should motion for either moderated or unmoderated caucuses to present different points of view on the given topic. Towards the beginning of the committee session, delegates usually begin with moderated caucuses to present ideas on a specific subtopic for an allotted amount of time. To enter into a moderated caucus, delegates should motion for a moderated caucus with a set total time and set speaker times on a specific subtopic.

Once the first moderated caucus is concluded, delegates may motion for an extension of the previous moderated caucus (only ½ of the original time), a new moderated caucus, or an unmoderated caucus. Delegates should be encouraged to enter into unmoderated caucuses to communicate with other delegates on possible solutions to the topic. These groups formed during unmoderated caucus, or blocs, work together to write working papers. After concluding unmoderated caucuses, delegates should return to their seats and motion for another unmoderated caucus to continue working on working papers or reenter formal debate by motioning for a moderated caucus. Depending on the current progress in the committee session, the Chair may prefer that delegates motion for specific forms of debate to effectively introduce working papers to the committee.

When delegates form blocs and gather ideas, they begin to write working papers, which are formal documents that outline solutions to the current topic. These concrete proposals change throughout the course of the committee because blocs sometimes change and new ideas are proposed during moderated and unmoderated caucuses. These working papers must have at least two sponsors and ⅕ of the committee sign as signatories. Once working papers are completed, delegates will submit them to the Chair; the working papers will be presented to the committee in the order they were submitted. Delegates in the Historical committee should keep in mind that working papers should not be influenced by future events outside of the committee.

After the submission of working papers, the Chair may look favorably upon presenting the working papers, where delegates who lead the bloc will read the working paper and then answer questions posed by other delegates in the committee during a Q&A panel. After concluding the Q&A panel, delegates can motion for a moderated caucus to discuss the presented working papers or an unmoderated caucus to consolidate working papers and propose amendments. Once amendments have been proposed and voted upon, delegates may motion to enter voting procedure.

During voting procedure, the room is locked, no one is allowed in or out of the room, and amendments are no longer accepted. Pages, Press Corps, and any observers must leave the room until voting procedure has expired. Delegates may motion how to vote during the voting procedure by a roll call vote, placard vote, dividing the question, or vote by acclamation. A draft resolution must gain a majority of the committee's "yes" votes to pass; however, delegates who are "present" may abstain from voting. Voting procedure will continue until all working papers are either passed or rejected by the committee.

Once all working papers are voted on, the flow of debate within the General Assembly. If there are multiple topics, delegates may motion to begin debating the second topic using the same process as the first.

Course of Debate: Crisis Committee

The flow of debate in Crisis Committees is structurally similar to traditional GA committees; however, parliamentary procedure is slightly adapted to enable more AD HOC decisions and emergency responses. Instead of passing a resolution at the end of committee, delegates in a crisis committee take action through the use of directives throughout the committee's ventures.

The committee begins with Roll Call, where delegates state whether they are present or present and voting. After Roll Call, delegates may open the Speakers List, providing a space to respond to the situation at hand. Afterwards, delegates can propose moderated or unmoderated caucuses, round robins, consultations of the whole, or other motions for debate.

The Chair will ask, “Are there any points or motions on the floor?” Delegates should raise their placards and wait to be called on by the Chair before proposing a motion. Motions will be voted upon from most to least destructive. If there are no points or motions, then the Chair will default to the Speakers List.

Delegates may motion for unmoderated caucuses as well. In contrast to traditional committees, unmoderated caucuses are used primarily for merging directives rather than creating blocs. This form of debate is less common in crisis committees than in GAs.

In addition to moderated and unmoderated caucuses, delegates may motion for a round robin in which each delegate gives a speech in the order of chairs around the room. Speaking time in a round robin is determined by the delegate proposing the motion, and the time is usually at most one minute. This form of a moderated caucus is used primarily after a crisis update, so delegates may discuss their position on resolving the issue at hand.

Crisis committees are different then a GA or AD-HOC as they involve both a front room and back room which influences the flow of debate. Crisis delegates will be faced with a generally time sensitive scenario, normal or fantastical (such as an alien invasion or the start of a war) and are responsible for developing solutions in the form of a directive. Throughout the committee, chairs will create crisis updates. Some of these crises may be timed, forcing delegates to quickly write directives to solve the issue.

Directives are the main instruments through which delegates take action. Unlike resolutions in traditional committees, directives are concise documents that can be written and passed quickly,

allowing delegates to respond immediately to unfolding situations. Directives do not include preambulatory clauses and are much shorter and more concise than most resolution's operative clauses. Delegates must remember to take actions within their country's/character's portfolio powers, or the powers available to a delegate based on their position. Once the directive has the required number of signatories (20% + 1 of the committee), it is sent to the Chair. From there, delegates may motion to introduce all directives and enter voting procedure. If the Chair deems it necessary to cap the number of directives, an unmoderated caucus would be necessary to merge directives.

When delegates enter the voting procedure, delegates may motion to introduce each directive individually and enter the voting procedure immediately after the introduction. There are no question-and-answer periods. Additionally, the delegate who motions to enter the voting procedure should specify a two-for, two-against speech and a speaking time for each speaker. The Chair will then choose the two-for and two-against speakers. If no delegate wishes to speak against the directive, then the directive automatically passes. Delegates will vote for directives similarly to resolutions by voting for, against, or abstaining.

After a directive has been introduced, delegates may raise objections and address the issues with amendments. Amendments in crisis committees are more loosely structured than amendments in traditional committees. Friendly amendments may be verbal rather than written, and unfriendly amendments must be voted on before its addition to the directive. The Chair may decide to vote on adding the amendment to the directive before voting on the directive as a whole.

After voting on directives for the pop-up crisis events, the flow of debate proceeds with delegates motioning for moderated or unmoderated caucuses.

On a group level, delegates need to work together to solve the crisis, however on an individual level, delegates need to focus on their individual "delegate crisis arcs". Delegate crisis arcs refer to the personal storylines that individual delegates build within a crisis committee. While the overall crisis arc covers the committee's collective narrative, delegate crisis arcs focus on how one delegate's actions, directives, and alliances develop over time to achieve specific goals. This is done largely through backroom notes. Upon arriving, delegates will receive two notepads, each representing a character that their delegation is connected to. These notepads serve as private communications sent by delegates to the crisis staff, through the voice of a letter between two characters allowing delegates to take covert or individual actions outside formal committee

debate. The crisis staff evaluates these notes and decides the in-simulation consequences, which can advance or undermine a delegate's strategy.This is a major consideration in award criteria.

Delegates can affect the flow of the crisis in three main ways, one through directives and backroom notes, as previously stated and JPD writing. Joint Personal Directives (JPD) are directives that delegates write in conjunction with other delegates in secret, which only require two sponsors. These directives get sent to the backroom, the committee staffers in charge of the crisis updates and depending on the development of the JPD, backroom staff will incorporate the JPD's content into the next crisis update. JPDs are other ways beyond crisis notes for delegates to effectively pursue their crisis arc.

Sources

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